



Twenty-five centuries of philosophy



Class video: <https://youtu.be/baLgUAaEbHQ>

The code leads to the video.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Before you start

1. Write down the names of all the women philosophers you know, from any era.
2. What do you think happened in philosophy between Aristotle and Thomas Aquinas? Answer in one sentence.
3. **At the end of the class.** Reread your two answers. Which names would you add? Would you change your sentence? Why?

While you watch the video

1. **Your prediction.** On the timeline, where will the biggest gaps be?

2. What did Hesiod's myth ask, and what did they start asking in Miletus? What is the *arche*?
3. **Stop and think.** Why do you think this change began in a Greek city? What is Vernant's answer?
4. Why was philosophy not a «Greek miracle»? Give three reasons.
5. Who tells us what we know about Hypatia? According to that source, why was she killed? Where do the quote and the portrait of her that go around the internet come from?
6. **Your prediction.** How did the rest of Aristotle reach Latin Europe? How did Thomas Aquinas read him?
7. **Stop and think.** Why did Christians, Muslims and Jews ask themselves the same question?
8. What objection did Elisabeth of Bohemia raise to Descartes, and with what reason?
9. **Stop and think.** Why did women philosophers hardly appear in the history that's usually told?

The line

Era	From, roughly	Its question	A male philosopher	A female philosopher
Antiquity	Thales, c. 600 BC			

Era	From, roughly	Its question	A male philosopher	A female philosopher
Middle Ages	c. 500			
Modernity	16th century			
Contemporary era	19th century			

The gap wasn't empty. Three names from those fifteen centuries:

Another tradition and one of its philosophers:

For you

1. Of the questions of the four eras, which one do you ask yourself?
2. Which woman philosopher on the line didn't you know? Why do you think you didn't know her?
3. Hipparchia defended what she had decided «about myself». What have you decided about yourself, even though others expected something else?
4. When you want to be right, whom do you quote? Have you ever checked whether they really said it?

Practice

1. Put these questions in time order and say which era each belongs to: what can I know for certain?, what is everything made of?, how do faith and reason fit together?, how should one live?

2. Elisabeth of Bohemia asked Descartes how a soul that only thinks can move the body. Which of the four features of philosophy, from the first class, do you see in her question?

3. Choose a woman philosopher from the timeline and look up, in a reliable source, one of her ideas and the work where she wrote it. If you cannot find any work, find out why.

Keep thinking

Twenty-five centuries from now, someone will draw this same line. What question will they put on our era? And who are we leaving in the margins today?

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